

‘Your life depended on meeting your quota.’

BAEK HYE-OK, recalling her experience as an inmate of a labor camp in North Korea.



WOOHAE CHO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

In two years in a camp, Baek Hye-ok made hair products like wigs and false eyelashes, North Korea’s biggest official export.

North Korea’s New Clout Has a Human Cost

By CHOE SANG-HUN

SEOUL — His nation is now a de facto nuclear power. Its economy is growing at the fastest pace in years. He has been courted by the leaders of China, Russia and the United States.

Kim Jong-un, the North Korean dictator, has emerged as an unlikely winner of the post-pandemic era. And his newfound strength rests on the systematic exploitation of his own people, which is actively facilitated by Moscow and Beijing.

By supplying troops and ammunition for Russia’s war in Ukraine, Mr. Kim is estimated to be reaping billions of dollars. Russia is repaying Pyongyang in advanced military technology and critical commodities like flour, pork and oil — goods his regime can

Kim Gains Power and Cash by Exploiting His People at Home and Abroad

then resell at home for profit.

But the human cost is staggering, for North Koreans at home and abroad.

Thousands of North Korean soldiers have been killed or wounded on faraway battlefields.

“I tremble as I await the daily reports, wondering how many soldiers were lost, whether they suffered reckless losses in the pursuit of bravery, whether they succumbed to fear or fell captive to the enemy,”

one young North Korean platoon leader wrote in his diary before he, too, died in combat.

Thousands more North Koreans toil behind the front lines, working in military drone factories, repairing war-damaged cities and building apartments across Russia to meet revenue quotas set by Mr. Kim’s government. With Moscow looking the other way to evade sanctions, many enter Russia on student visas but never see a classroom — instead sleeping in shipping containers and enduring 14-hour shifts with hardly any days off.

Closer to home, China is openly importing North Korean coal in violation of United Nations sanctions, satellite imagery indicates. Defectors say the commodity is

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Case Unsettles A Consensus On Psychiatry

By ELLEN BARRY

During the weeks before she killed her children, as she tried one psychiatric drug regimen after another, Lindsay Clancy kept a careful record of the symptoms that troubled her.

“Intrusive thoughts,” she wrote in her diary on Dec. 8, 2022. The next day, “horrible intrusive thoughts.” On the 11th, 12th and 13th, she recorded more “horrible thoughts.” By the 14th, something had changed: the intensity. “HORRIBLE thoughts,” she wrote, underlining both words.

Three and a half years later, Ms. Clancy’s case has put the psychiatric changes women experience in the aftermath of childbirth at the center of a national debate. At her murder trial, which ended in a hung jury, her defense argued that she was psychotic and could not be held legally responsible for killing her three children; prosecutors argued that she was depressed, but rational.

That she was tormented by intrusive thoughts — distressing ideas or images that pop unbidden into a person’s mind — is clear to both sides. Even the state police seemed to understand their importance; one piece of evidence they collected was a book Ms. Clancy had in her kitchen, titled “Good Moms Have Scary

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slavery could be achieved only through the Union Army’s defeat of the Confederacy, but the human cost of the war he deemed necessary was now strewn before him. The corpses in blue and gray bloating in the July heat. The wounded begging for the mercy of death. And here, in the muck at his feet, the bold lieutenant of Battery G, Fourth U.S. Artillery, his son Bayard.

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A Reporter on Gettysburg’s Losses, and His Own

By DAN BARRY

GETTYSBURG, Pa. — After the battle the heavens above Gettysburg wept, the rain falling hard upon the blood-dappled fields, the bullet-shorn trees, the tens of thousands of dead, dying, maimed. It was the Fourth of July, the foundational anniversary for a nation now at war with itself, and all was mud.

A war correspondent for The

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New York Times named Samuel Wilkeson Jr. trudged through the violated Pennsylvania landscape on a solitary quest. The weary journalist was searching for one particular Union soldier who was said to have had his leg blown off. His teenage son.

Wilkeson believed the end of

An engraving of Lt. Bayard Wilkeson, the son of a reporter at The Times, at Gettysburg in 1863.

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INTERNATIONAL 4-14

A Health Crisis in Mexico

Communities are paying for the government’s decision decades ago to flush away waste in a rural valley. PAGE 8

Tiny Territory Now in Demand

Politics and a popular TV show have raised the profile of an obscure French outpost off Newfoundland. PAGE 6

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Tribe Feels Betrayed by Wall

A confrontation on Native land threatens to upend decades of uneasy cooperation between the Tohono O’odham Nation and the United States. PAGE 15

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Not Brothers, but Close

Matthew McConaughey and Woody Harrelson on a long friendship, and the DNA test they won’t be taking. PAGE 10

93, and Far From Done

In her 80s, Liliane Rovère charmed audiences as Arlette in “Call My Agent!” She’s back in the role. PAGE 1

SPORTS 25-28

Unease on the Ice

A workout led by a former Green Beret left an Arizona State men’s hockey player on life support and a team grappling with the aftermath. PAGE 25

ARTS & LEISURE

The New Season

A look at what’s coming this fall, including theater, film, dance, pop music and more. Above, Julia Louis-Dreyfus.

SUNDAY BUSINESS

How DraftKings Uses A.I.

Former employees of the online betting giant say it uses data science to target losing gamblers with promotions and has resisted using the tech to protect those at risk of addiction. PAGE 6

Different Type of Glass Ceiling

Being female or a person of color has long been seen as a disadvantage in hiring and promotion. A new study shows that being a first-generation college graduate is also an issue. PAGE 1

White House Enforces Ban On 3 Outlets

Lawsuits Over the First Amendment Likely

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A.I. FEARS CALLED A HOAX BY TRUMP, BUT AIDES DIFFER

TONE TURNS CAUTIOUS

While Tech Titans Warn About Rules, Advisers Warn About Risks

This article is by David E. Sanger, Jonathan Swan, Cecilia Kang and Dustin Volz.

President Trump made clear over the past week that he views fears that A.I. could lead to mass extinction as a “HOAX,” and that he sees opponents of data centers as people who “want to end up being backwards and poor.”

People who have discussed the subject with Mr. Trump in private say his outbursts are rooted in worries that if the artificial intelligence boom fueling the American economy slows down, the market could crash and recession could quickly follow.

His anti-regulatory, anti-slowdown outbursts have been encouraged by a slice of Silicon Valley’s most influential voices. Chief among them has been David Sacks, the venture capitalist who interceded to weaken an executive order in May that would have required safety reviews of new A.I. models. Mark Zuckerberg of Meta and Jensen Huang of Nvidia have also spoken to the president. All have advised Mr. Trump that the bigger risk is being overtaken by Chinese competitors.

But inside the administration, the debate is far more complex, and there are other voices in Mr. Trump’s ear, urging caution.

The more cautious tone inside the White House reflects a growing concern that despite the strategic challenge posed by China, a summer of A.I. surprises has

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GREENLAND DEAL

The president’s threats to seize the territory left its people on edge. Details of an accord are scarce. PAGE 12

White House Enforces Ban On 3 Outlets

Lawsuits Over the First Amendment Likely

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